MONTHLY UPDATE

Equatorial Guinea: monthly update, September – October 2026

Edition of 2026-10-12 · compiled by Claude Opus from the documents in the Corpus repository

> *Developments summarised from sources published between the beginning of last month and today.*

SUMMARY OF THE MONTH · GOVERNANCE · ICT INFRASTRUCTURE · DPI · INCLUSION · DATA · GEOPOLITICS

Summary of the month

Facebook and TikTok have been blocked, with bandwidth throttled, since 2 September. The government launched a satellite broadband service on 9 September and ordered its sales routed through the state operator. The Chamber of Deputies approved a revision of the press law unanimously on 11 September, and four criminal complaints were lodged on 16 September under the 2024 law on social media and computer crime. The statistics institute presented its ninth national yearbook on 25 September.

Governance

Strategies, plans and policies

Two plans and no strategy is still the position. The transport ministry's half-year plan sets the country's first published broadband target, 85 per cent coverage through 34 new towers by the end of 2026, and a World Bank team opened a four-day session in Malabo in early September to finalise a national digital economy strategy — on a diagnostic that found no interoperability framework and no digital skills data held.

Legislation and regulation

The press bill cleared the lower house: the Chamber of Deputies unanimously approved on 11 September the bill replacing the 1997 press law, which covered no digital journalism.

The 2024 social-media and computer-crime law was used in court for the first time on the public record. On 16 September lawyers for the vice-president lodged four criminal complaints at a Malabo investigating court against a digital newspaper's journalist and three others under articles 2, 50 and 60, using article 2 to reach conduct committed outside the country. The complaints came while Facebook and TikTok remained blocked.

A Senate committee approved by consensus its final report on the press freedom bill and sent it to the plenary.

Public debate and participation in policymaking

Two enforcement bodies agreed to exchange information rather than to publish any. The attorney general's office and the national anti-corruption commission agreed a permanent coordination mechanism on 3 September: institutional liaison points for continuous contact, an information-exchange protocol and periodic reviews. No protocol text, data categories, safeguards or first review date is published, and neither body publishes a caseload against which any of it could be read.

ICT Infrastructure

Connectivity

The terms followed on 9 September, when the government launched the service officially and reserved its sale to the state, with a dedicated revenue account and privately signed contracts cancelled. No licence text, tariff or subscriber figure is published.

Access then narrowed for everyone else. Since 2 September bandwidth has been throttled and Facebook and TikTok unreachable without a VPN, after a viral video accusing the vice-president of corruption whose author was arrested; no order has been published and the information ministry did not answer questions. The Vice-President instructed the finance ministry on 7 October 2026 to investigate and expedite the financing file for the operator's network agreement with the vendor, slowed by Treasury payment arrears to the operator.

Cybersecurity

The Vice-President named the alleged members of a network leaking official documents of the Presidency of the Government, alleging that a registry official extracted several years of administrative files and handed over a hard drive on the pretext of a project to digitise the Presidency's archives. The account is the government's own, and no judicial finding is on file.

DPI

Digital Payments and Fintech

The one payments instrument in the window is a standing one, surfaced by a sales pitch: a Presidency order of 2025 prohibits cash collection of any tax, fee or contribution in the administration, requiring official bank accounts or authorised electronic platforms, cited when a domestic e-wallet provider presented itself to the transport ministry as a collection channel. The order's text, and whether collection has moved off cash, are not in the record held.

Sectoral management information systems

Customs also appears on a list of intended work: an undated page of the PAMFP public finance reform programme names a second phase of the SYDONIA customs software for Bata, Mongomo, Ebebiyin, Corisco, Aconibe, Cogo and Rio Campo, with computer equipment and network links to carry it beyond Malabo. No installation, cost or timetable is attached to it.

Other GovTech and e-Gov

The government announced a digital edition of the official gazette with free online access and search.

Inclusion

Access to services

The refugee agency's rights mapping put an absence on the record this month: Equatorial Guinea has acceded to the refugee treaties and enacted no domestic status determination law, so no registration or documentation system follows from one.

Data

National statistics

The statistics institute went out to the ministries rather than waiting for their returns. A ministry-by-ministry supervision tour of statistical services began on 2 September at the interior and education ministries and runs to 9 September, ordered by the national statistics council's eighth session of 27 August, to assess each service's state and consolidate the national statistical system. No findings, service inventory or report from the tour is published, and the account is the institute's own.

On 25 September INEGE presented the ninth national statistical yearbook, covering the last five years, naming weak administrative registers, undigitised processes and poor interoperability between information systems among its outstanding challenges. It restated the plan for the fifth population census and the first agricultural census without giving dates.

Geopolitics

EU activities

The Commission's own country page states the position plainly: no European Union delegation and no country programme for Equatorial Guinea, with ties run from a neighbouring capital.

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